

Trust, privacy, and security – key business imperatives

- Deep fakes, misinformation, biases, frauds... all the trust, privacy, safety, and security issues related to AI will continue to rise, and governments will slowly keep introducing guardrails to safeguard their people. So, compliance officers must be on their toes to catch and implement any policy changes quickly.
- Enterprises will adopt AI security platforms, which provide seamless visibility and control across AI applications, including key features for AI accountability, transparency, tech resilience, ethical alignment, regulatory compliance, and privacy engineering.
- As customers become more aware of the privacy and security risks in AI systems, they are likely to seek privacy-centric AI models, where processing happens on-device or on-premise.
- Data provenance will soon become a key aspect of trust. It requires policies and systems to track the origin and movement of data, including the 'who, where, when, why, what, and how' of changes.
- We will see a rise in ethical questions and legal scuffles regarding the unauthorised use of



copyrighted content to train AI systems.

- As the amount of AI-generated slop increases, the value of authentic human-generated content will rise, especially in creative spheres. Publishers are likely to include seals of authenticity to certify honest, human-generated content.
- Manpower skilled in cybersecurity, especially quantum-safe systems and cross-platform vulnerability management, will be greatly in demand.

Sustainability and circularity – must-do, not can-do!

- The Paris Agreement mandates all entities to achieve net-zero emissions by 2050. Tech majors are well on



track, and the others will have to catch up too this year because governments are under pressure to implement necessary regulations on an urgent basis.

- There will be a drive to build sustainability and circularity into business strategies, as customers start looking for these. Already tech majors have started favouring vendors who are committed to sustainability.
- Companies will start encouraging a repair, reuse, and recycle culture.
- They will have to plan for waste, water, and carbon management. It will become imperative to reduce carbon emissions at all levels, while also offsetting emitted carbon by purchasing carbon credits.
- It is expected that organisations will increasingly use AI in the coming year to optimise their energy usage and plan their net-zero roadmaps.

In 2026 and coming years, we shall see not just trade but also technology emerging as a clear sign of power. In the changing face of geopolitics, nations across the world are striving for digital sovereignty. They are aiming to create and own their talent, research, and technology, right from hardware, AI models, apps, and data centres, to telecom networks and even space above their territory. Clearly, this is a great opportunity for regional players to step up their game.

This is going to be an interesting year for the tech industry – not just globally but in India too! We will keep you updated of developments and disruptions along the way. **EFY**